Apex Systems

Executive summary

Apex proposes a security-led procurement portal with a detailed integration architecture. The higher price funds dedicated technical specialists and controlled rollout.

Understanding of the requirement

Build a supplier onboarding and procurement analytics portal with SSO, ERP integration, reporting, role-based access, audit logs, migration, training and post-launch support. This fictional proposal addresses the same procurement request as the other three fixtures.

Proposed solution and architecture

The solution uses containerized application services, a PostgreSQL transactional store, and a separate reporting layer. SAML SSO and role-based access protect buyer and supplier workspaces. An API gateway integrates purchase orders and supplier master data with ERP through authenticated REST endpoints. Failed ERP messages enter a retry queue with idempotency keys and an operations dashboard. Capacity tests target 500 concurrent users with 95th percentile response under two seconds.

Delivery, team and milestones

Delivery takes 16 weeks: discovery in weeks 1-2, integration design in weeks 3-4, portal build in weeks 5-10, migration and acceptance testing in weeks 11-14, then controlled rollout in weeks 15-16. The team includes a project manager, solution architect, three engineers, one security specialist and one tester. A weekly risk register tracks ERP access, data quality and acceptance dependencies.

Commercial proposal (USD)

Cost item	Amount / assumption
Implementation	USD 245,000 fixed fee
Annual support	USD 32,000 from year two
Three-year disclosed total	USD 309,000
Taxes	Excluded; customer statutory rate applies
Scope assumptions	One ERP, one SSO tenant, up to 10,000 suppliers
Exclusions	Travel, extra integrations and cloud consumption

Payment assumptions

Payment schedule: 20 percent at signed discovery, 40 percent at build acceptance and 40 percent at launch. Change requests require written scope and price agreement. Customer supplies ERP credentials, cleans source data and appoints acceptance reviewers.

Security, support and experience

Security, privacy and risk controls

Encryption uses TLS 1.3 in transit and AES-256 at rest. Administrators use MFA and least-privilege roles. Audit logs retain user and administrative changes for 365 days. Monthly vulnerability scans and an independent pre-launch penetration test are included. Recovery targets are RPO four hours and RTO eight hours, validated in a restore exercise. Apex states an ISO 27001-aligned control framework; no certification certificate is attached.

Support, experience and references

Support operates 24x5 with a one-hour response target for priority-one incidents. Quarterly service reviews and an escalation manager are included. The fictional project team describes three comparable procurement deployments. Fictional reference: Harbor Components procurement manager; reference contact verification is not included.

Risks and clarification points

All supplier claims require procurement due diligence. Any omitted commitment remains unconfirmed, not implicitly included. Pricing excludes taxes and variable cloud usage. The customer must validate integration access, data readiness and reference assertions before award.

Fictional-data notice

Every company, project, reference and commercial amount in this proposal is invented for teaching. This is not an actual commercial offer or proof of certification.